

Partnership for Safe Water Distribution Program - Disinfectant Residual Update

March 2026

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The Bureau of Laboratory Services is responsible for administering compliance with the water quality monitoring requirements under both the federal Safe Drinking Water Act (SDWA) and state regulations. As monitoring locations that were temporarily not visited after the onset of COVID-19 are now being revisited, over 600 drinking water samples are collected from 79 monitoring locations.

Regarding disinfectant residual, the Partnership for Safe Water has a numerical goal that 95% of monthly routine samples be within the following range:

Total Chlorine Residual ≥ 0.50 mg/L and ≤ 4.0 mg/L

PWD has met this goal for Partnership Years encompassing June 1, 2017 through May 31, 2021 (the Partnership year begins June 1st and runs through May 31st). From November 2017 – July 2019, less than 1% of routine samples were below the Partnership goal of 0.50 mg/L for every month. The last month that PWD did not meet the 95% Partnership goal was September 2016 (7.27% of monthly samples were below 0.50 mg/L), with the following two Septembers having less than 2% of samples below 0.50 mg/L and meeting Partnership's monthly goal. The highest percentage of monthly Partnership samples not meeting the goal in the previous three calendar years (2023 – 2026) was 2.62% in Sep 2023.

A total of 773 samples were collected in March 2026, up from 605 samples collected in February. 547 field chlorine residual samples were collected in accordance with DRR/RTCR requirements. PWD adjusted the sampling schedule and frequency starting in the second half of March 2020 due to the ongoing COVID-19 pandemic. PWD is still collecting more than the required 360 samples for RTCR/DRR compliance. Starting in November 2020, PWD began to resume sampling from some routine fire and police stations for the RTCR/DRR compliance program. The selected fire and police stations are the locations that are sampled monthly as part of the DBP monitoring program as well. PWD also began resuming sample collection samples from additional fire and police stations earlier this year that were not being sampled during the first year of the pandemic. Starting in July 2020, PWD resumed monthly distribution Disinfection By-Product sampling from the normal fire and police station locations. As of October 2021, Chestnut Hill Hospital is no longer be sampled from and the Chestnut Hill Pressure District Pump Station replaced the hospital as the routine sampling location for the Chestnut Hill pressure district.

March 2026 had 0 samples below 0.50 mg/l throughout the distribution system, and 0 samples below 1 mg/l.

Table 1: Sample Summary

-	Count	Description
Total DRR Samples for March 2026	547	
Num of samples < 1.00 mg/L	0	Below PWD distribution system goal of 1.00 mg/L
Num of samples >0.5 mg/L, <1.00 mg/L	0	Meets PfSW goal of 0.50 mg/L. Does not meet PWD distribution system goal 1.00 mg/L
Num of samples >0.15 mg/L, <0.50 mg/L	0	Meets PADEP minimum distribution residual required (0.15 mg/L). Does not meet: PfSW goal (0.50 mg/L), PWD distribution system goal (1.00 mg/L)
Num of samples <0.15 mg/L	0	Does not meet: PADEP minimum distribution residual required (0.15 mg/L), PfSW goal (0.50 mg/L), PWD distribution system goal (1.00 mg/L)

Total THM values increased compared to last month. 0 locations had single sample TTHM results above the MCL of 80 ppb. Single sample TTHM results above the MCL are not an MCL exceedance as compliance with the MCL is based on Locational Running Averages.

HAA5 values increased compared to last month. 0 locations had single sample HAA5 results above the MCL of 60 ppb. Single sample HAA5 results above the MCL are not an MCL exceedance as compliance with the MCL is based on Locational Running Averages.

Below is a monthly range of DBP distribution values for the last 13 months. Values that exceed the MCL for a single sample are highlighted in red, and samples that exceed the operational goal of 75% of the MCL are in yellow.

Table 2: Monthly Minimum and Maximum Total Trihalomethanes and 5 Haloacetic Acids

Date	Total THM Minimum	Total THM Maximum	5 HAA Minimum (ug/L)	5 HAA Maximum (ug/L)
2026-Mar	25.3	36.3	35.6	43.3
2026-Feb	18.3	25.4	16.8	35.4
2026-Jan	16.5	26.1	18.1	44.9
2025-Dec	19.4	26.6	24.2	31
2025-Nov	25.1	49.7	22.7	44.2
2025-Oct	44.6	74.3	21.9	35.9
2025-Sep	38	61.9	17.5	26.7
2025-Aug	58.5	82.7	32.2	49.2
2025-Jul	60.3	90.3	2.1	64.5
2025-Jun	35.6	51.2	24	48.8
2025-May	36.4	53.1	22.6	46.4
2025-Apr	28.8	65.4	46.4	85.9
2025-Mar	26.4	37.7	37.8	56.5

TTHM LRAA MCL = 80 µg/L ; Operational Goal = 60 µg/L

HAA5 LRAA MCL = 60 µg/L ; Operational Goal = 45 µg/L

Table 3: Percent of Grab Samples < 0.50 mg/L TCL2 Residual - Entire PWD Distribution System - by Month

Year	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2026	NA	NA	0	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
2025	0	0	NA	NA	NA	NA	1.7	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
2024	0	0	0	0	0	0.5	0.5	1.3	1.3	0.4	0.2	0
2023	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.31	0.91	2.62	0.88	0	0
2022	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.15	1.06	0.87	0.15	0	0
2021	0	0	0	0	0	0	1.82	0	0	0.47	0	0
2020	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.57	1.86	2.78	0.65	0	0
2019	0	0	0	0	0.13	0.28	0.51	1.17	2.71	0.92	0	0

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Key

> 5.0 Percent Fails Partnership Goal

4.0 to 4.99 Percent

3.0 to 3.99 Percent

0 to 2.99 Percent